STYLES & MOVEMENTS

A starter history map. Movements are complex and regionally varied, not fixed decorating recipes.

Style_ID	Movement / Style	Period	Geographic Context	Historical Context	Core Ideas	Spatial Characteristics	Forms / Motifs	Materials / Colours	Key Designers	Representative Works
ST001	Arts and Crafts	Late 19th–early 20th c.	Britain; international influence	Reaction to industrial mass production and poor-quality manufacture.	Craftsmanship, honest materials and unity of art and making.	Handcrafted furniture, built-ins, natural motifs and considered detailing.	Timber, stained glass, handmade tiles, natural textiles.	William Morris; C.F.A. Voysey	V&A overview	S001
ST002	Art Nouveau	c. 1890–1914	Europe; regional variations	International decorative movement shaped by nature-inspired design and new materials.	Unity of applied arts; flowing organic forms.	Curving lines, integrated ornament and bespoke interiors.	Stained glass, iron, wood, ceramic and botanical pattern.	Victor Horta; Hector Guimard; Antoni Gaudí	Historic interiors and architecture	
ST003	Art Deco	1920s–1930s	Paris; global spread	Modern decorative style linked to industrial progress, luxury and urban culture.	Geometry, modern materials, craftsmanship and glamour.	Symmetry, stepped forms, sunbursts and streamlined geometry.	Lacquer, chrome, marble, veneers and glass.	Ruhlmann; Donald Deskey; Eileen Gray	Radio City Music Hall; ocean-liner interiors	
ST004	Bauhaus	1919–1933; continuing influence	Germany; global	School uniting art, craft, architecture and industry.	Functional design, experimentation and prototypes for modern life.	Simple forms, open plans and integrated furniture.	Steel tube, glass, plywood, textiles and concrete.	Walter Gropius; Marcel Breuer; Marianne Brandt	Bauhaus buildings and furniture	S002
ST005	De Stijl	1917 onward	Netherlands; international	Art and design movement seeking universal harmony through abstraction.	Reduction to geometric elements and primary colours.	Planes, grids, right angles and spatial composition.	Painted planes, timber, glass and primary colours.	Gerrit Rietveld; Piet Mondrian	Rietveld Schröder House	
ST006	Mid-century Modern	c. 1945–1969	United States; Scandinavia; global	Post-war design responding to new materials, housing and industrial production.	Function, optimism, human scale and new manufacturing.	Open plans, indoor-outdoor links, clean lines and organic forms.	Teak, walnut, plywood, fibreglass, steel and glass.	Florence Knoll; Eames; Saarinen; Jacobsen	Eames House; Case Study Houses	S003
ST007	Scandinavian Modern	20th century	Denmark, Sweden, Norway, Finland	Modern design shaped by climate, craft traditions and everyday life.	Beauty, utility, simplicity and accessible quality.	Light-filled spaces, simple furniture and natural textures.	Light woods, wool, leather, ceramics and paper.	Alvar Aalto; Arne Jacobsen; Hans Wegner	Nordic domestic interiors and furniture	
ST008	Brutalism	1950s–1970s	Britain; Europe; global	Post-war architecture emphasising structure, mass and material honesty.	Legibility of structure and social purpose.	Monolithic forms, exposed structure and raw surfaces.	Exposed concrete, brick, timber and steel.	Alison and Peter Smithson; Le Corbusier	Barbican; Unité d'Habitation	
ST009	Postmodernism	late 1970s–1990s	Europe; United States; global	Reaction against perceived limits of strict modernist functionalism.	Pluralism, historical quotation, irony and symbolism.	Bold shapes, colour, mixed references and ornament.	Laminates, plastics, stone and coloured finishes.	Ettore Sottsass; Michael Graves; Robert Venturi	Memphis designs; Portland Building	
ST010	Minimalism	1960s onward	International	Reduction of form and detail; varied philosophical and cultural roots.	Clarity, restraint, proportion and attention to space.	Few elements, controlled light and precise detailing.	Concrete, stone, timber, glass and plaster.	John Pawson; Tadao Ando; Donald Judd	Minimalist houses, galleries and installations	
ST011	Mediterranean Revival	19th–20th century	Mediterranean regions; global adaptations	References drawn from Mediterranean vernacular traditions.	Climate response, indoor-outdoor living and regional craft.	Courtyards, arches, textured walls and shaded transitions.	Terracotta, stone, timber, lime plaster and tile.	Regional architects and contemporary reinterpretations	Courtyard houses and resort interiors	
ST012	Memphis Design	1981 onward	Italy; international influence	Postmodern collective challenging modernist restraint.	Play, colour, visual contradiction and anti-functional symbolism.	Graphic geometry, asymmetry and bold pattern.	Laminates, plastics and coloured finishes.	Ettore Sottsass; Nathalie du Pasquier	Memphis furniture and objects	
ST013	Geometric Modernism, English Pop Eclecticism, High-Glamour Mid-Century.	Late 1950s through 1970s (Mid-Century Modern to Glamorous Eclecticism).	Bold graphic content; the iconic "Hicks Hexagon", repeating sharp diamonds, chevrons, and optical art (Op-Art) geometric textiles.	Post-war British design revolution; overthrew stuffy, traditional English country house decor with youthful, pop-art energy and jet-set international flair.	Clashing old with new; mixing priceless antique furniture with modern abstract art and ultra-contemporary patterns in a single space.	Highly structured, formal, and symmetrical layout geometry; pioneered the "Tablescape" (artful, meticulously curated compositions of objects grouped on flat surfaces).	Bold graphic content; the iconic "Hicks Hexagon", repeating sharp diamonds, chevrons, and optical art (Op-Art) geometric textiles.	High-contrast industrial and luxurious pairings; polished chrome, brass, slick lacquer finishes, plush velvets, and heavily textured tweeds.	Ashley Hicks (Son/legacy manager), India Hicks (Daughter), Mark Hampton (strongly influenced by his geometric layouts).	Britannic House offices (London); Okura Hotel luxury suites (Tokyo); Personal estates (Britwell House / The Grove); Design of the iconic geometric carpet used in The Shining movie hotel set.
ST014	Modern Maximalism, Hollywood Regency Revival, Organic Modernism, Luxury Eclecticism.	1995–present (Late 1990s Hollywood Regency revival to contemporary organic maximalism).	High; heavy use of striking Memphis Group geometries, bold stripes, hand-drawn linear art, abstract murals, and high-contrast optical graphics.	Led the early-2000s boutique design-hotel boom; single-handedly dismantled 1990s beige minimalism by introducing a high-octane, West Coast luxury maximalism.	Juxtaposition of raw and refined; design as sensory storytelling; mixing disparate historical eras with an unapologetic, risk-taking scale.	Multilayered, immersive, and sensory environments; spaces rely on dramatic focal points, grand scale architectural openings, and theatrical furniture curation.	Sculptural silhouettes, chubby or chunky seating forms, totemic artifacts, massive organic curves, ribbed/fluted architecture, and heavy plaster reliefs.	Materials: Heavily veined exotic marbles, rough pitted travertine, unlacquered brass, liquid-slick lacquer, and hand-hewn wood. Colors: Earthy neutrals (terracotta, sand, mud) clashing with sulphur yellow, chartreuse, pink, and deep teal.	Extensively influenced by Ettore Sottsass, Gio Ponti, and Milo Baughman.	Santa Monica Proper Hotel, Viceroy Santa Monica, BG Restaurant at Bergdorf Goodman, Malibu Surf Shack, and her *Side Hustle* experimental gallery.
ST015	Accessible Luxury, California Casual, Tailored Transitional, Warm Minimalism.	1995–present (Rose to massive global prominence via The Oprah Winfrey Show starting in 2002).	Subdued and restrained; heavily favors neutral textures, classic ticking stripes, understated block prints, and herringbone patterns over bold graphics.	Widely credited with democratizing high-end interior design in the early 2000s; steered public taste away from sterile, mass-manufactured matching furniture sets toward soulful, personal curation.	A home should tell the story of who lives there; design should be highly personal, layered with sentimental objects, and look collected over time rather than decorated overnight.	Grounded, symmetrical, and practical layouts; prioritizes deep comfort, readable space flow, and intimate furniture groupings layered with curated tabletop vignettes.	Tailored straight lines, clean classical architectural moldings, soft rounded mid-century profiles, artisanal pottery silhouettes, and rustic geometric carvings.	Materials: Bleached white oak, heavily distressed antique leather, unpolished marble, raw linen, woven rattan, and brushed brass. Colors: Timeless neutral foundations; heavily relies on warm sandy tones, off-whites, charcoal, soft taupe, and organic olive greens.	Deeply influenced by European antiquarians, Madeleine Castaing, and his partner Jeremiah Brent.	High-end global residential projects under Nate Berkus Associates, his iconic commercial collections with major retailers, and authoring the bestselling book The Things That Matter.
ST016	Modern American Glamour, Happy Chic, Mid-Century Pop Maximalism.	1993–present (Launched his first ceramic collection at Barneys New York in 1993 before scaling to a global brand).	Very high and punchy; signature black-and-white Greek key tracks, massive chevrons, bold geometric bargello patterns, and high-contrast optical art stripes.	Reinvigorated mid-2000s American interior design by replacing serious, uptight historical traditionalism with an irreverent, pottery-rooted sense of humor, optimism, and vivid color.	Irreverent luxury and "Happy Chic"; firmly believes that a home should make you happy, that comfort is non-negotiable, and that boredom is the ultimate design sin.	Symmetrical, clean-lined modernist architectural backdrops layered with theatrical, high-personality furniture groupings and meticulously arranged pottery/sculpture vignettes.	Sculptural ceramic profiles, surrealist body parts (lips, hands), acrylic monoliths, brass starbursts, bullet profiles, and stylized animal forms.	Materials: High-gloss lacquer, polished brass, clear acrylic/lucite, unglazed biscuit porcelain, and plush velvet. Colors: Saturated combinations; bright turquoise, hot orange, mustard yellow, royal blue, and crisp white foundations.	Deeply influenced by Bonnie Cashin, Alexander Girard, Piero Fornasetti, and Andy Warhol.	The Parker Palm Springs Hotel (flagship hospitality work), Eau Palm Beach Resort & Spa, and his eponymous global retail boutiques and ceramic art lines.
SS017	Aero Modern, Warm Traditionalism, Vintage Transitional, American Soft Modern.	Late 1980s–present (Co-founded Aero Studios in 1992, defining the 1990s and 2000s transitional design movement).	Low to Moderate; explicitly shuns jarring pop-art graphics to focus heavily on soft historical weaves, quiet pinstripes, and understated organic textures.	Championed the "Warm Modern" aesthetic in downtown New York during the 1990s; single-handedly rescued historical, weathered antiquities from being lost to sterile, hard-edged minimalism.	The marriage of modern and traditional styles; editing a home to look orderly, tailored, and structured while remaining highly functional, comfortable, and deeply grounded in design history.	Meticulously balanced and architectural; relies on custom-scale built-in cabinetry, crisp traditional millwork, and comfortable furniture groupings that follow clean symmetrical grid lines.	Streamlined mid-century silhouettes, refined industrial fittings, clean turn-of-the-century schoolhouse shapes, retro wall clocks, and box-pleated tailored profiles.	Materials: Unlacquered brass, oiled bronze, zinc surfaces, dark-stained mahogany, vintage leather, and utilitarian stoneware. Colors: Muted, deeply nostalgic tones; soft sage greens, warm chalky creams, deep charcoals, rich camels, and slate blues.	Strongly influenced by Edward Wormley, Gilbert Rohde, and classical American makers. Originally partnered with William Sofield at Aero Studios.	Flagship lifestyle store and practice Aero Studios, iconic vintage-forward lighting collections for Visual Comfort, and his masterwork design monographs American Modern and Library House.
SS018	New American Classic, Elegant Minimalism, Clean-Lined Traditionalism, Refined Modern Country.	1985–present (Rose to prominence in the late 1980s and 1990s as a leading voice of New American Classicism).	Very low; explicitly eschews loud or jarring geometric graphics, heavily favoring solid textiles, subtle tone-on-tone textures, and serene natural horizons.	Helped redefine American luxury in the 1990s by stripping away the heavy, dark, chintz-laden English country layers of the 1980s in favor of bright, airy, and light-filled spaces.	Design should provide a sense of calm and escape; focuses on cerebral simplicity, the beauty of negative space, and a profound reverence for natural light and panoramic views.	Expansive, airy, and uncluttered layouts; masterfully frames window views, utilizes high ceilings, and designs perfectly scaled, symmetrical floor plans that maximize a sense of openness.	Tailored straight lines, subtle architectural crown moldings, pristine Parsons-style silhouettes, understated clean tracking profiles, and soft, gentle curves on custom upholstery.	Materials: Bleached oak, fine plaster, Belgian linen, polished nickel, sisal, and sheer silk panels. Colors: A signature airy palette dominated by crisp whites, soft creams, pale grays, seafoam blushes, sand, and watery blues.	Deeply respects the classic proportions of Albert Hadley and the understated, architectural discipline of Angelo Donghia.	High-end luxury residences across the Hamptons, Palm Beach, and Manhattan; author of design monographs Interior Portraits and Dream Spaces; regular AD100 and Elle Decor A-List hall of famer.
SS019 SS020 SS021 SS022 SS017	Traditional English Country House, Classic American Eclecticism, Layered Maximalism.	1967–present (Spent 22 foundational years at the legendary Parish-Hadley firm before establishing Bunny Williams Inc. in 1988)	Moderate; strongly relies on classic botanical prints, dense damasks, heritage chintzes, and traditional ticking stripes rather than hard-edged modern geometries.	Carried the torch of elite 20th-century high-society decorating directly into the modern era; expertly bridged the gap between grand, aristocratic style and casual, livable family homes.	A room should first and foremost be comfortable, deeply functional, and feel as though it was naturally assembled over decades; design should never look artificially or rigidly decorated overnight.	Multilayered, inviting, and conversation-centric floor plans; dense but highly organized furniture layouts featuring multiple intimate seating groups, heavily packed bookshelves, and layered surfaces.	Classical architectural moldings, soft rolled-arm sofas, tailored English slipcovers, animal-shaped accent pieces, botanical elements, and Chinoiserie pagodas.	Materials: Polished mahogany, hand-woven rattan, lacquered faux-tortoiseshell, glazed ceramic table lamps, and woven rush matting. Colors: Warm, grounding tones; terracotta, rich moss greens, butter yellows, soft ochre, sky blues, and creamy whites.	Deeply shaped by her mentors Sister Parish and Albert Hadley; long-time design collaborator with her late husband, antique dealer John Rosselli.	Her legendary personal Connecticut estate (Manor House), showcase master spaces at Kips Bay, her global Bunny Williams Home furniture brand, and her seminal design book An Affair with a House.